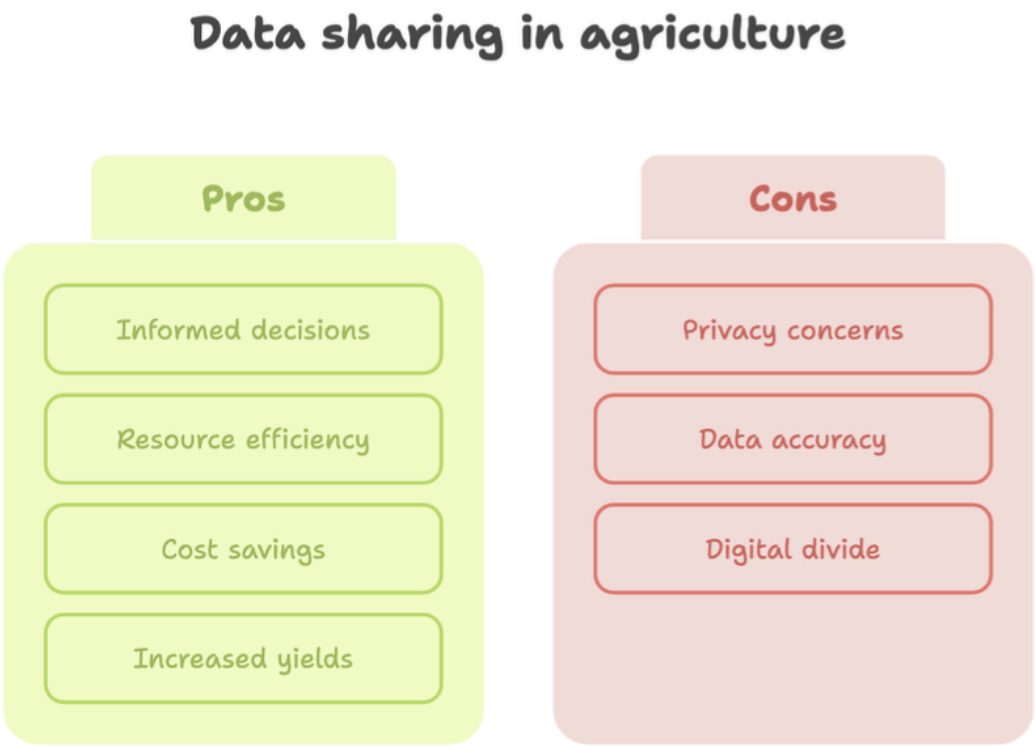
Farmer Data Groups:

Farmers share information like soil test results, weather conditions, and crop performance on a digital platform. Smart tools analyze this data to offer useful and personalized advice. This helps farmers make better decisions—like when to plant or how to manage pests. By using timely insights, they can improve yields and reduce farming risks.



How it is used abroad:

- **Denmark & US**: Farmer data groups help smallholders access advanced tools, leveling the playing field with large agribusinesses.

- **France**: Farmers share data to negotiate better deals on seeds and insurance, leading to cost savings.

- **Netherlands**: Shared data enables smarter farming—using less fertilizer without reducing crop yields.

- **Israel**: AKOLogic helps farmers manage everything from soil and weather to pests and compliance through a real-time, cloud-based platform. It supports global standards and offers full traceability across the supply chain. This empowers even small farmers to farm smarter and more sustainably.

Why India Needs it Now:

- Most Indian farmers work in isolation and lack access to organized, data-sharing platforms. Without timely or reliable information on soil health, weather, or crop performance, planning and decision-making become difficult. Farmer Data Groups can fill this gap by enabling farmers to share critical data and receive actionable insights—leading to improved yields, efficiency, and resilience.

- By joining data groups, small farmers can share experiences, access better insights, and negotiate collectively for inputs and markets.
- Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs) are well-placed to lead this movement by connecting farmers who already have trust-based relationships.

- As internet access expands across rural India, data-driven agriculture will become essential for productivity and sustainability.

- Farmers who adopt these tools early—especially with accurate forecasting models—will be better prepared and more competitive.

Market Size:

Metric	India Agritech Market	Global Digital Farming Market
Market Value (2024)	USD ~815 million	USD 26.76 billion
Projected Market Value (2032/33F)	USD 2.275 billion (by 2033F)	USD 71.96 billion (by 2032)
CAGR (Forecast Period)	~13.5% (2025–2033 F)	~12.8% (2024–2032)
Source	UnivDatos	Fortune Business Insights

Market entry strategies:

- Collaborate with Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs): connect to farmer networks, build trust, and enable shared data platforms akin to eNAM/ONDC models.
- Integrate with government-backed digital platforms (e.g., Agri Stack, MahaVedh, ONDC) to increase reach and streamline onboarding.
- Conduct vernacular marketing campaigns, influencer-led awareness drives, and demo farms through agricultural universities to build local credibility.
- Research farmer internet habits, offline vs online purchasing patterns, and input-cost dynamics to localize your solution—similar to successful strategies in Gujarat and Maharashtra. (Like MahaAgri-AI Policy (2025–29)).

- Build a robust ecosystem including precision-input providers, micro-finance institutions, and logistics or supply-chain players (following AgTech Value Proposition Canvas)—co-ownership models like IFFCO Bazar and e-Choupal are effective.

Top startups in this domain:

1. Abhinav Farmers Club: A farmer-led cooperative initiative founded in Maharashtra, supports polyhouse cultivation and direct-to-retail supply chains.

2. Millet Network of India: A grassroots movement of 5,000+ farmers (predominantly women) across villages, sharing data and organic practices for millet cultivation to promote water-efficient, subsidy-aware farming .

3. Digital Green: An NGO-powered initiative where farmers create and share instructional videos. It engages 150,000+ farmers across 2,000+ villages, combining peer learning with data gathering via its app “Loop”.

4. Kisan Network: A tech-enabled farmer marketplace founded in 2018, connecting smallholders directly to buyers using blockchain for traceability. It enables group selling and collective bargaining.

5. Ekgaon: A social-enterprise model active since 2006, connecting 300,000 farmers through a mobile-based utility and market platform. It enables community-led data sharing and service access .

Government support:

1. **Digital Agriculture Mission (DAM)**

- Launched in 2024 with a ₹2,817 cr budget to build Agricultural Digital Public Infrastructure (AgriStack + Decision Support System).
- Will create farmer IDs for ~11 crore farmers and develop soil-crop-weather databases to support precision advisory and traceability.

2. **eNAM & ONDC Integration**

- **eNAM (National Agricultural Market)** links 1300+ mandis digitally, providing transparent market prices.
- **ONDC (Open Network for digital Commerce)** has onboarded ~5,000 FPOs (target 10,000), enabling collective digital selling—critical for farmer

group platforms. An **FPO** is an entity formed by farmers where they collectively own, manage, and make decisions.

3. **Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF)**

- A ₹1 lakh cr facility (2020–2029) offering low-interest loans with 3% subsidy and credit guarantees for FPOs and startups to build supply chain and precision-farm assets

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